

DO NOT DUPLICATE // EYES ONLY

# CLASSIFIED BRIEFING: OPERATION EAGLE

SUBJECT: The Soul of a New Machine // Westborough Division

"Riveting... a well-paced story of corporate invention and intrigue." — *Washington Post Book World*

**APPROVED**

SN: 78-WE-452-OE

ROUTED: 1978-CURRENT



**TOP SECRET**

# THE CAPTAIN

A GOOD MAN IN A STORM

**SUBJECT:** Tom West

**ROLE:** Leader, Eclipse Group (Amber Terminal accent)

**traits:** Mysterious, Intense, Low & Spooky Laugh.

"That fellow West is a good man in a storm."  
— Prologue: The Northeaster

## Character Profile

**STATUS:** Awake (4 Nights)

**UNIFORM:** Watch cap, heavy gray sweater

**SCENT:** Wool and Sea Salt

**OPERATING MODE:** Thrives on the edge of disaster.





# THE FORTRESS: BUILDING 14A/B

DATA GENERAL HQ // WESTBOROUGH, MASS.

## PROPERTY ASSESSMENT CARD

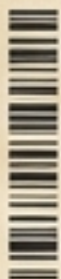
**LOCATION:** Junction Route 495 & Mass Pike  
**ARCHITECT:** None (Designed by Engineers)  
**COST:** \$19/sq ft (Industry Avg: \$34/sq ft)  
**DEFENSES:** Roof-mounted TV Cameras,  
Narrow Windows



**THE FIRST SIGN  
YOU SEE SAYS DON'T.**

"What they call tough auditing, we call thievery."





TOP SECRET

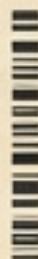
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# THE OBJECTIVE

## THE "FUCK YOU" THEORY



DEFINITION: Accumulating enough "loot" (\$1 Million) to negotiate without fear.  
 GOAL: Never go back to your father's gas station.  
 STATUS: The "Darth Vader" of the Industry.





**THEY SAY IBM'S ENTRY INTO  
MINICOMPUTERS WILL  
LEGITIMIZE THE MARKET.  
THE BASTARDS SAY, WELCOME.**

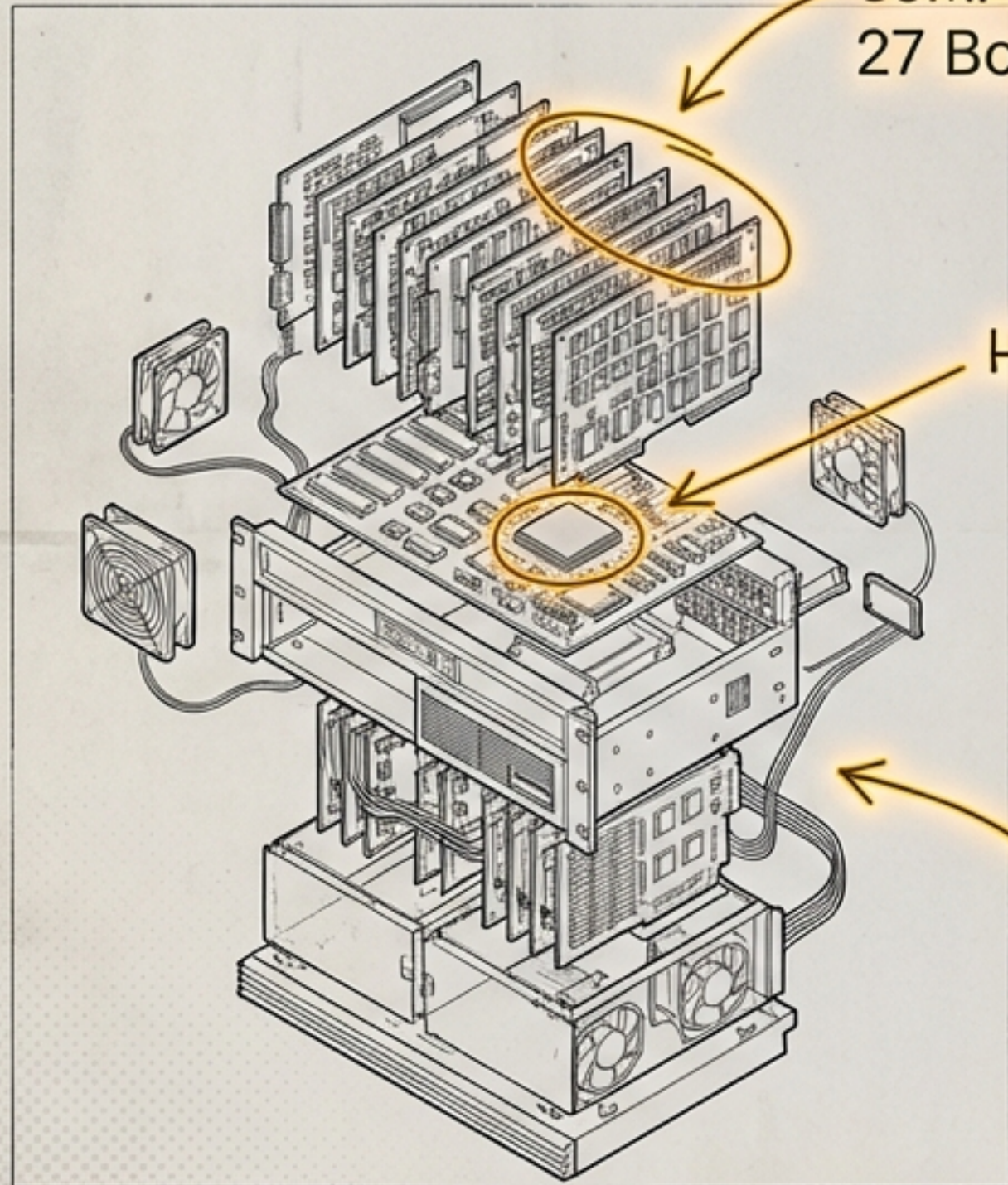
**TOP SECRET**

**CONTEXT: GUERRILLA MARKETING WARFARE**

- **Data General:** The **violent son** of DEC.
- **Tactics:** Hiring bellboys to distribute flyers; The "Hertz-Avis" strategy.
- **Result:** DEC warnings only drove customers to DG.



TOP SECRET



COMPLEXITY:  
27 Boards in CPU.

HARDWARE COST:  
~\$22,500.

RETAIL PRICE:  
>\$100,000.

# THE THREAT

## VAX 11/780 AUTOPSY

### THE INFILTRATION:

**Subject:** Tom West

**Action:** Covert disassembly of competitor machine.

**Finding:** VAX is bureaucratic, complex, and expensive.

"I'd been living in fear of VAX for a year." — Tom West



TOP SECRET

# THE 32-BIT GAP: AN EXISTENTIAL CRISIS

## 16-BIT



4-DIGIT SYSTEM

Capacity:  
**65,000** Unique  
Addresses

Scale:  
A Small Town

THE  
INDUSTRY  
SHIFT

## 32-BIT



7-DIGIT SYSTEM

Capacity:  
**4.3 Billion**  
Unique Addresses

Scale:  
A Metropolis

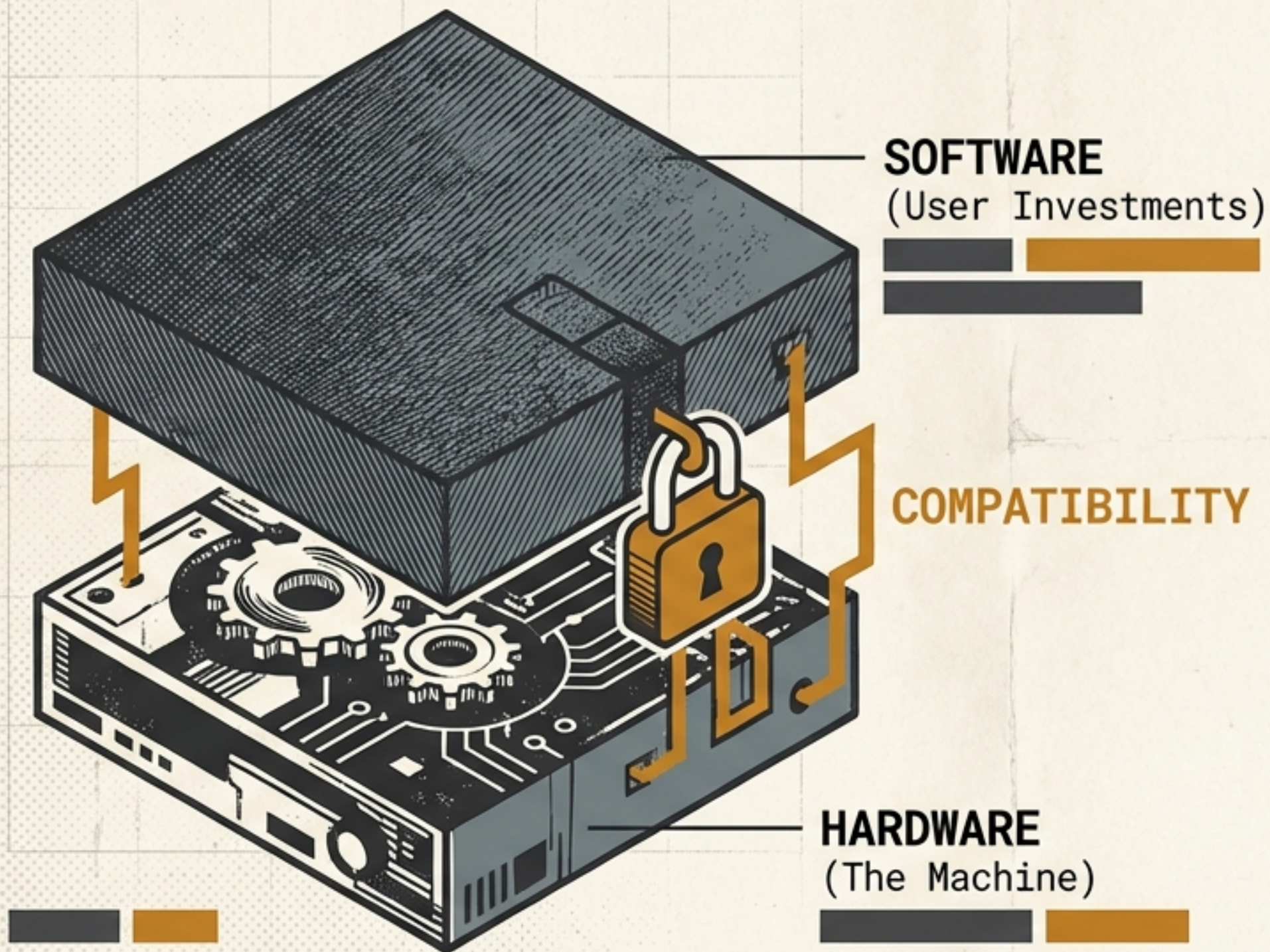
“ **redacted** **strategic assessment**: We're gonna get schmeared if we don't react to **VAX**. ”



**TOP SECRET**

# STRATEGIC IMPERATIVE

## THE MARKET MARRIAGE



### THE IBM 360 LESSON:

Customers are "married" to their software. The ultimate weapon is Compatibility.

### MISSION GOAL:

Build a new 32-bit machine that runs old 16-bit software. Avoid the "Market Survey" risk.

*"From a marketing point of view what a win that would be!"*



**TOP SECRET**

# BETRAYAL

THE EXODUS TO NORTH CAROLINA

## IMPACT:

- Westborough engineers abandoned.
- Morale: All-time low.
- Morale low.
- Perception: "Dangled before them and then pulled away."



**Boston Globe**

## DG EXPANDS SOUTH.

"...Research Triangle Park area has a different feel... The ambition level is different... There is a can-do attitude." — CEO de Castro



**TOP SECRET**

# FAILED INSURGENCY

## THE FALL OF "EGO"



**CODENAME: EGO**

(One step back from FHP/HAL/IBM)

**TECHNICAL FLAW:**

Reliance on "Mode Bit"  
(Switching mechanism)

**THE BATTLE:**

"The Big Shoot-out at HoJo's"  
(Howard Johnson's Motor Inn)

De Castro looked around the room  
and said, "It's a dilemma." ...  
"Okay, we'll stop building EGO."

**MISSION FAILED**



## THE OFF-THE-WALL PERIOD

> WELCOME TO ADVENTURE  
> YOU ARE IN A MAZE OF TWISTY LITTLE PASSAGES, ALL ALIKE.  
> A PIRATE APPEARS.  
> HE SAYS: "HAR. HAR."

STATUS: The Vacuum.

ACTIVITY: Engineers wandering strange, awful labyrinths.

PROJECT: 'Victor' (A Canard/Fake Project).



**TOP SECRET**

# THE RESURRECTION: PROJECT EAGLE



## THE COVER STORY (Management)

- **Concept:** Insurance Policy
- **Description:** A boring, fast Eclipse.
- **Threat Level:** Low.

## THE REALITY (The Team)

- **Concept:** The Win
- **Description:** A Hot Rod. Fast as greased lightning.
- **Mandate:** 1% Research, 99% Development.

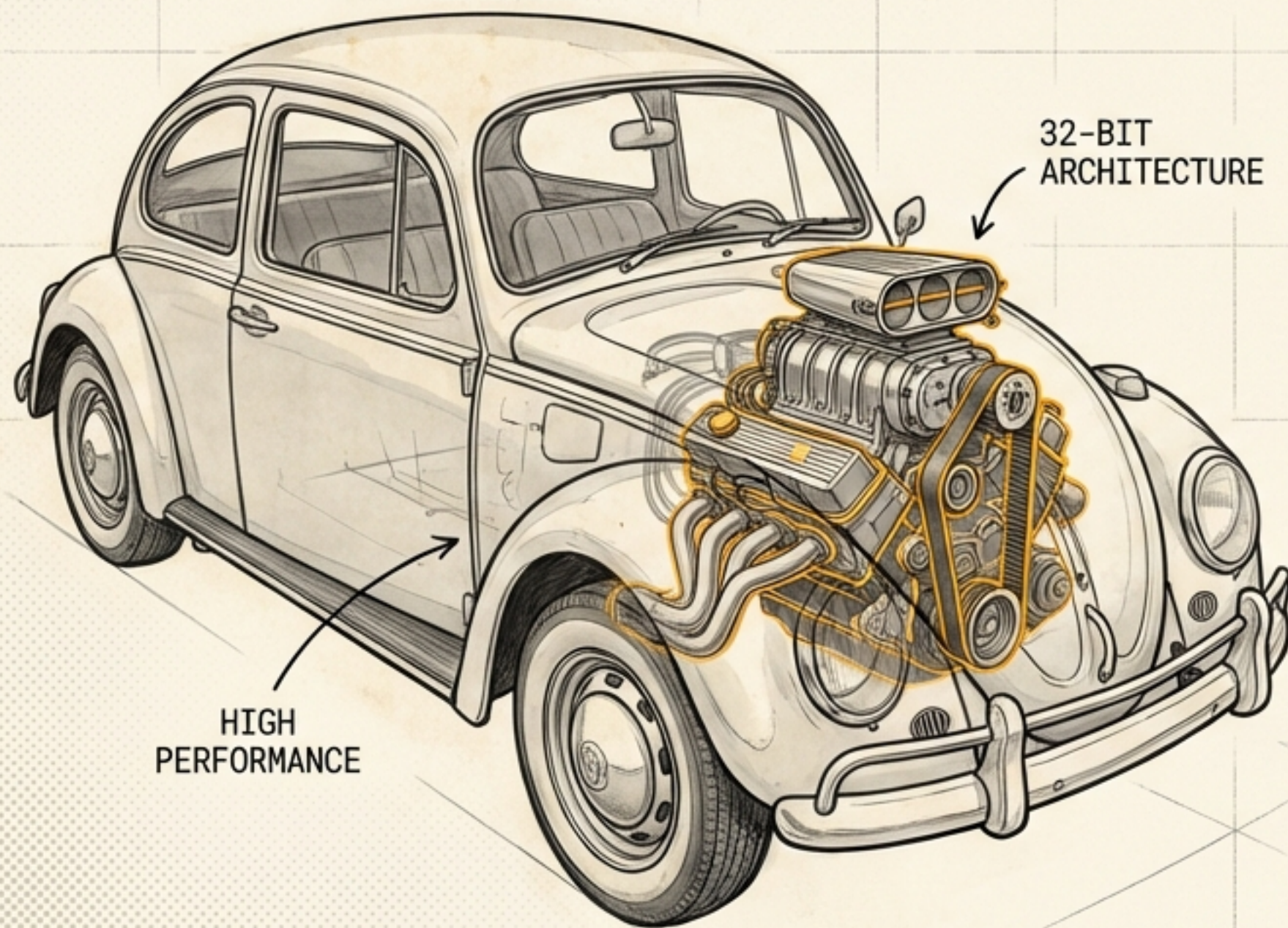
**"I tried to sell it externally as not much of a threat."**



**TOP SECRET**

# THE BLUEPRINT

A BAG ON THE SIDE OF THE ECLIPSE



**THE CHALLENGE:** Create 32-bit architecture without the banned "Mode Bit".

**THE SOLUTION:** Extend logical address space while keeping compatibility.

**PERCEPTION:**

**Critics:** A "Kludge" (messy assembly).

**West:** "The Win."

**METAPHOR:** It might look like a VW Beetle, but think what they could put under the hood."



TOP SECRET

# RECRUITMENT: SIGNING UP

**TARGETS:** The "Kids"  
(Young Engineers) &  
Software Team.

**THE PITCH:** "Are you  
guys gonna do it or sit  
on your ass and  
complain?"

**THE REWARD:** "Get a  
machine out the  
door with your  
name on it."

**ATMOSPHERE:** The basement became a  
commuter train of intensity.



# MISSION PARAMETERS

**CLEAN SHEET  
OF PAPER.**

# TRIUMPH OF PACKAGING.

**STRATEGY:** Unlike DEC (Minimize Risk), DG Maximizes the Win.  
**DEADLINE:** One Year.  
**CONDITION:** Survival.

[REDACTED]  
[BANEN / TECHNICAL RE-GU/RAT / BNUISD/08 / TECHNICAL / UTSB-05 / AGSD]



**TOP SECRET**

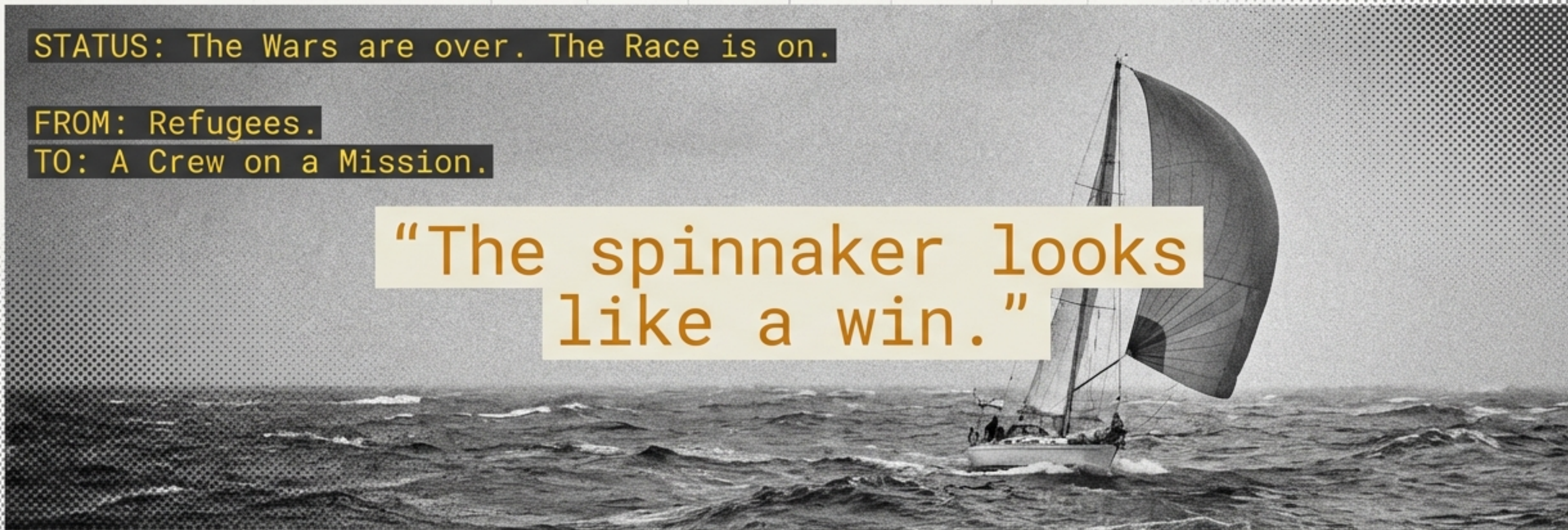
# INTO THE STORM

**STATUS:** The Wars are over. The Race is on.

**FROM:** Refugees.

**TO:** A Crew on a Mission.

"The spinnaker looks  
like a win."



**Roboto Mono**

**DATA GENERAL DOSSIER // REF. INTO\_THE\_STORM\_80.png // CLASSIFIED LEVEL 4**